

Figure 4.4: (a) diagrammatic, **(b)** Simple raceme



Figure 4.4: (c) diagrammatic, **(d)** Spike

branched central axis. Each branch is a **spikelet**. Sessile flowers are formed in acropetal succession on the axis. A pair of inflorescence bracts called **glumes** is present at the base. Each sessile flower has a **lemma** (bract) and a **palea** (bracteole). Tepals reduced to colourless scaly leaves (lodicule). Each flower has stamen and pistil only. Example: Paddy, Wheat, Barley, *Sorghum*.

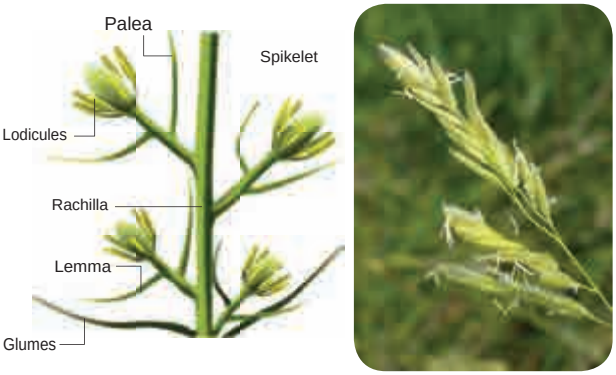


Figure 4.4: (e) diagrammatic, **(f)** Spikelet

d. Catkin: **Pendulous spikes** with a long and drooping axis bearing small unisexual or bisexual flowers. It is also



Figure 4.4: (g) diagrammatic, **(h)** Catkin

called **ament**. Example: *Acalypha hispida*, *Prosopis juliflora*, *Piper nigrum*.

e. Spadix: An inflorescence with a fleshy or thickened central axis that possesses many unisexual sessile flowers in acropetal succession. Usually female flowers are found towards the base and male flowers are found at the apex. Entire



Figure 4.4: (i) diagrammatic, **(j)** Spadix

inflorescence is covered by a brightly coloured or hard bract called a **spathe**. Example: *Amorphophallus*, *Colocasia*, *Phoenix*, *Cocos*.

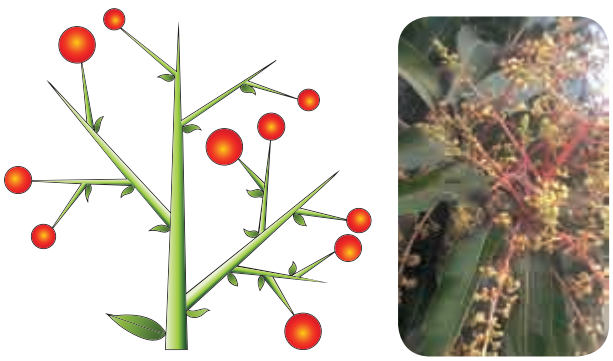


Figure 4.4: (k) diagrammatic, **(l)** Panicle